Reality (***Brahman***). At the falling away of the body, he will be liberated (*mukta*) from the series of births. Meanwhile, he awaits the natural exhaustion of his remaining stock of ***karma***, at which point he will be released from rebirth.

Jnana (cognition): according to ***Nyaya-Vaisheshika***, a cognition is a type of quality (***guna***) that occurs the principle of identity or soul (***atman***). Cognitions are understood as one-off psychological episodes, concrete unique occurrences (rather than as beliefs, which are settled dispositions, or what are understood as propositions in the Western tradition), receptive of information about the environment that causes them. Cognitions may be true or false. Some are stored as memories and may feature in complex thoughts.

While playing a crucial role in the subject's interaction with the physical world, cognitions are not aware of themselves, in accordance with the principle that nothing can exercise its proper function on itself. We are primarily aware of the world outside the mind, not our own thoughts. A cognition is a particular thought that always has some object, real or imagined: it is always awareness *of* something.

A cognition is consciously registered when it becomes the object of another thought (***anuvyavasaya***). The subject does not have to be explicitly aware that they know something to have a piece of knowledge. All that is required is that the cognitive state be the result of a reliable causal process.

There are two varieties of cognitive episodes: preconceptual (*nirvikalpa*), and conceptual and expressible in words (*savikalpa*). The former may be compared to glancing at a scene without noticing anything in particular (indeed it may not even be explicitly registered in